CODING MANUAL
CHILDHOOD OBESITY-RELEVANT POLICY DOCUMENTS

Background and Scope

Evidence-based decision-making is critical to the formulation of effective policy and practice, but despite efforts to increase the availability of research-based knowledge in the policymaking domain, use of research evidence by policymakers has been infrequent, inconsistent, and at times misinformed. The primary objective of this study is to test the idea that the news media have an important role in connecting policymakers to policy-relevant research evidence. Specifically, this project explores three research questions:

1. What factors influence policymakers' acquisition, adoption, and use of research evidence in news reports?
2. In what ways, direct and indirect, does the inclusion and representation of policy-relevant research evidence in news reports facilitate the use of research evidence by policymakers?
3. What, if any, is the relative contribution of policy-relevant research evidence in news media to policymakers' use of research evidence in policymaking processes?

To answer these questions, this study will track federal policymakers' (i.e., legislators in Congress and government bureaucrats) use of research evidence by collecting, coding, and analyzing a comprehensive set of publically available policy documents (e.g., transcripts of congressional bills, committees/sub-committees hearings, testimonials, floor debates, government-issued memos and reports, transcripts of public speeches or comments) on the topic of childhood obesity, focusing on the scope, type, context, and timing of policymakers' use of research evidence relative to the progression of the legislative process (see ***Appendix A***) for each of four key federal policies from 2000-2014:

1. School nutrition;
2. School physical education and activity standards;
3. Consumption of sugary snacks and drinks; and
4. Advertising and marketing food to children.

School nutrition. One major influence on nutrition in schools comes from federal school lunch and breakfast programs. Federally subsidized school meals are required by Congress and the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) to meet nutrition standards and comply with the Dietary Guidelines for Americans (see the Child Nutrition and WIC Reauthorization Act of 2004). Approximately 31 million children in the United States participate in the National School Lunch Program, and approximately 11 million participate in the school breakfast program. The foods offered in these programs are federally regulated and must meet certain guidelines to qualify as a reimbursable school meal. Another category of foods available in schools is "competitive food" or food sold outside of the formal meal programs. These alternative options may come from vending machines, fundraisers, school stores, or a la carte items offered during lunchtime. Federal legislation now gives the USDA jurisdiction not only over federal meal programs, but over competitive foods as well. Thus, both types of federal policies are considered in this study.

School Physical Education and Activity Standards. There is no federal law requiring physical education to be provided to students in the American education system. In general, federally sponsored policies regarding physical education and activity in schools include encouraging students' participation in and equal access to programs for both boys and girls, providing funding for equipment and staff training, and requiring local districts to set programming goals and conduct evaluations (see the Carol M. White Physical Education Program, established in 2001 under No Child Left Behind). Beginning with school year 2006–07, the Child Nutrition and WIC Reauthorization Act of 2004 (P.L. 108-265, Section 204) required school districts participating in the National School Lunch Program or other child nutrition programs, such as the School Breakfast Program, to adopt and implement a wellness policy. The Healthy, Hunger-Free Kids Act of 2010 (P.L. 111-296) continued this requirement and, for the first time, requires the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) to develop regulations that provide a framework and guidelines for local wellness policies. This study will examine use of research evidence in the context of these specific and similar federal policies.

Limiting availability of sugared beverages and foods. Sugar-sweetened beverages and foods may be the single largest driver of the obesity epidemic in America. Two major efforts to address the availability of sugared beverages and foods targeted vending machines in schools (i.e., removing sugary drinks and foods and replacing them with healthy options) and taxed consumptions of these foods. The most common proposal has been an excise tax of a penny per ounce for any beverage with added sugar, with some or all of the revenue to be used for obesity prevention programs (an excise tax is preferable to a sales tax, as the price would be added before the consumer makes the decision to purchase a product and there would not be the incentive to purchase large containers). This study focuses on the policy debate that surrounded proposed federal legislation to institute (but also to prevent states from instituting) taxes on sugared beverages.

Food marketing regulation. In response to the growing body of scientific evidence on the effects of food marketing, government agencies, public health experts, and consumer advocacy groups have called for restrictions on food marketing, particularly marketing targeting children. Efforts to restrict food marketing targeted to youth have involved government regulation as well as voluntary pledges developed by food companies. The food industry has responded to criticism of its marketing practices by implementing self-regulatory initiatives, namely the Children's Food and Beverage Advertising Initiative (CFBAI), which claims to modify the products shown in food advertisements in an effort to encourage healthier dietary choices and lifestyles among youth. However, reports have concluded that the CFBAI pledges include significant gaps that have resulted in few improvements in the food marketing landscape. Government regulation may be necessary to help protect youth from the effects of food marketing. In theory, these regulations should involve a uniform set of standards delineating the specific nutrition criteria required for foods shown in advertisements and should clearly define the age of a child as well as forms of media that should be regulated. This study focuses on the policy debate that surrounded proposed federal legislation to regulate food marketing.

Policy Documents Selection and Eligibility Criteria

The U.S. Government Printing Office (GPO) online database (FDsys) provides comprehensive access to official publications from all three branches of the federal government and is therefore the primary source for searching, identifying, and retrieving relevant federal policy documents regarding each of the four childhood obesity-related policies this study focuses on from 2000-2014. The dataset is organized in collections of policy documents by type. The following are considered for the purpose of this study:

- Transcripts of congressional bills (including amendments)
- Transcripts of Congressional committees' hearings
- Transcripts of House and Senate committee reports
- Transcripts of congressional floor debates

- Transcripts of proposed rules, regulations, and executive orders
- Transcripts of Presidential speeches and comments
- Transcripts of policy or legislative analyses produced by the Congressional Budget Office, the Congressional Research Service, and the General Accounting Office

In addition, the pool of policy documents to be analyzed in this study includes relevant policy documents produced by the following governmental agencies:

- The U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
- The National Institutes of Health (NIH)
- The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC)
- The Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality (AHRQ)
- The Food and Drug Administration (FDA)
- The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)
- The U.S. Department of Education (ED).
- The Health Resources and Services Administration (HRSA)
- The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)
- The U.S. Department of Defense (DoD)
- The Federal Trade Commission (FTC)
- The Federal Communications Commission (FCC)
- The White House

To be included in this study, relevant policy documents must meet the following eligibility criteria:

- Published between the years 2000-2015.
- The topic of childhood obesity is a major focus of the document.
- The document includes at least one explicit reference to evidence regarding childhood obesity.
- The content of the document is relevant to one or more of the four specific policies listed above (see ***Appendix C*** for a list of policy proposals relevant to each topic).

Policy Document Coding Scheme

In general, the coding of each policy document (see ***Appendix B*** for the specific coding instrument) involves extracting information regarding three levels of analysis – document, person, and evidence – such that people and research evidence that appear in the same document may be linked.

Document-Level Coding

The document-level coding scheme is designed to:

- Record basic identifying information (publication date, title, publication number) for each document coded such that it can be identified in the dataset.
- Classify the source of the document by *type* (e.g., bill, committee hearing, speech, etc.), *policy system* (e.g., House, Senate, President, NIH, etc. – including sub-systems such as committees and sub-committees), and *specific policy focus* (of the four types of policies considered in this study).

Person-Level Coding

The person-level coding scheme is designed to record the following information regarding <u>each</u> person who is listed as author or contributor in the document:

- Full name.
- Title (e.g., Representative, Director, Dr., Mrs., etc.).
- Affiliation (party, institutional or organizational affiliation, if applicable).
- Official role (e.g., committee chair, committee member, staff member, etc.).
- Contribution (author, witness, speaker, etc.).

Note: Complete person information may not be available in all types of documents (e.g., congressional bills). In such cases, missing information will be obtained from a relevant attribution file (e.g., congressional directories).

Evidence-Level Coding

The basic unit of analysis in this study is evidence mention (which is inclusive of both research and non-research evidence).

IMPORTANT: **evidence** (e.g., "a recent study found that 1-in-5 American children are obese") **is not the same as claim** (e.g., many American children are obese"). **We are only interested in coding evidence**.

A ***research evidence mention*** is any explicit reference to evidence or fact generated by means of a systematic investigation (research). This definition is inclusive of evidence generated through the use of scientific experiments (or randomized trials), observational studies (e.g., surveys, observations, interviews), epidemiological or medical studies, research syntheses (e.g., meta-analysis, systematic reviews, and recommendations made by expert panels or scientific task forces) as well as public opinion polls conducted with a population-representative sample of respondents. A ***non-research evidence mention*** is any explicit reference to anecdotal or non-scientific evidence such as information obtained from personal experience, a testimonial, or a news story.

Each evidence mention is coded for the following:

- **Who** references the evidence mention that appears in the document (i.e., name of author, speaker, witness, etc.). Provide any relevant identifying information that is given for the individual.
- **What** is the nature of the evidence mention, specifically (1) *type of evidence* (e.g., research study), (2) the *source of evidence* (e.g., government research, academic research, news source, personal experience, etc.); and (3) *quality of evidence* (based on the methodology used to produce the evidence).
- **How** is the evidence mention presented in the document, specifically, (1) *format* of presenting the evidence (statistics, narrative, table, graph, etc.); (2) *valence* (i.e., whether evidence is presented in the context of support, opposition, or neutral stance toward the policy discussed); and (3) *interpretation* (i.e., evidence suggests a problem, evidence suggests cause of or responsibility for the problem, evidence suggests a probable effective solution to the program, or evidence suggests a particular policy response to the problem)
- **Why** or the purpose/goal of referencing the evidence (i.e., instrumental, conceptual, or tactical use – see *Appendix B* for specific coding instructions)

Coding Procedure

All coding will be performed using Dedoose (http://www.dedoose.com/), a web application for organizing and analyzing textual, audio, and video data. A user guide is available at http://www.dedoose.com/userguide/. Instructional videos are available at http://www.dedoose.com/resources/#.

Each coder will need to set up an individual account with Dedoose which is linked to the project. Once logged in, coders will be able to upload and code documents using the procedure outlined in ***Appendix D***. In-person hands-on training sessions will be provided to all coders by senior members of the research team.

There are several important rules that all coders must follow:

1. You must be connected to the Internet to be able to use Dedoose.

2. Remember to clear your web browser cache BEFORE beginning the coding task each time (Dedoose may not function well otherwise). If you are not sure how to do this, see https://kb.iu.edu/d/ahic.

3. You should only code the documents assigned to you. Please verify that the document you code was assigned to you before you begin the coding task.

4. Never delete or modify a document you did not create. Do not change the coding of a document another coder worked on, unless you were asked to do so by a senior member of the research team.

5. When in doubt regarding a particular coding decision, use the Memo tool in Dedoose to point to (by including the row numbers of the excerpt in the document) or copy and paste the relevant text and to explain what you find confusing.

6. If you encounter a technical problem or have a coding-related question that impede your ability to make progress on the task, please post an email describing the problem or question to epikhelp@gmail.com or post a message to the project's Slack address (https://epikcoders.slack.com/) and a senior member of the research team will get back to you as soon as possible.

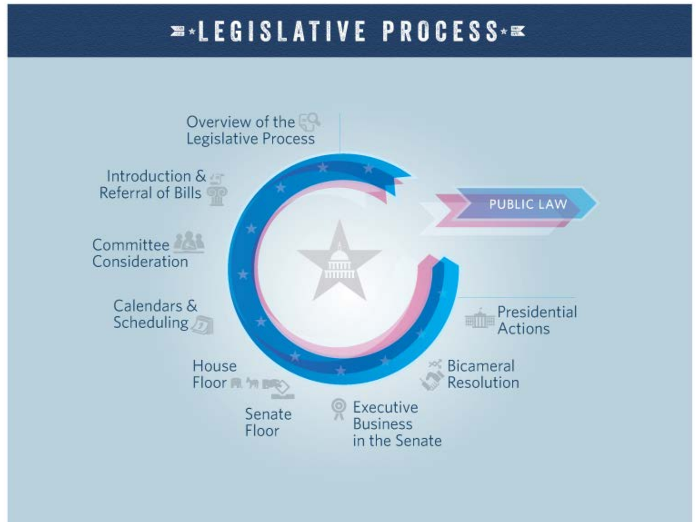
Quality Control Procedure

Quality work entails careful scanning of each document for relevant information, paying close attention to details, maintaining fidelity to the coding instrument and coding procedure, and achieving acceptable degree of precision in applying codes. The quality of coders' work will be periodically assessed by senior members of the research team. If problems are detected, coders may need to receive additional training on the task.

In addition, intercoder reliability will be assessed by having all coders code the same sample of documents and assessing the degree of agreement among coders. If intercoder reliability fails to reach an acceptable level, additional training will be provided and intercoder reliability will be reassessed.

Appendix A

Overview of the Legislative Process[1]



Article I of the U.S. Constitution grants all legislative powers to a bicameral Congress: a House of Representatives and a Senate. The two chambers are fundamentally equal in their legislative roles and functions. Only the House can originate revenue legislation, and only the Senate confirms presidential nominations and approves treaties, but the enactment of law always requires both chambers to separately agree to the same bill in the same form before presenting it to the President.

In both chambers, much of the policy expertise resides in the standing committees – panels of members from both parties that typically take the lead in developing and assessing legislation. Committee members and staff focus much of their time on drafting and considering legislative proposals, but committees engage in other activities, as well. Once law is enacted, Congress has the prerogative and responsibility to provide oversight of policy implementation, and its committees take the lead in this effort.

Step 1: Introduction and Referral of Bills. Bills and joint resolutions may become law if enacted during the two-year Congress in which they were introduced. Simple resolutions and concurrent resolutions are the other options; these measures cannot make law, but may be used by each chamber, or by both, to publicly express sentiments or accomplish internal administrative or organizational tasks, such as establishing their rules for proceeding. Members and their staff typically consult with nonpartisan attorneys in each chamber's Legislative Counsel office for assistance in putting policy proposals into legislative language. Members may circulate the bill and ask others in the chamber – often via Dear Colleague letters – to sign on as original co-sponsors of a bill to demonstrate a solid base of support for the idea. Upon introduction, the bill will receive a designation based on the chamber of introduction, for example, H.R. or H.J.Res. for House-originated bills or joint resolutions and S. or S.J.Res. for Senate-originated measures. It will also receive a number, which typically is the next number available in sequence during that two-year Congress.

In the House, bills then are referred by the Speaker, on the advice of the nonpartisan parliamentarian, to all committees that have jurisdiction over the provisions in the bill, as determined by the chamber's standing rules and past referral decisions. Most bills fall under the jurisdiction of one committee. If multiple committees are involved and receive the bill, each committee may work only on the portion of the bill under its jurisdiction. One of those committees will be designated the primary committee of jurisdiction and will likely take the lead on any action that may occur. In the Senate, bills are typically referred to committee in a similar process, though in almost all cases, the bill is referred to only the committee with jurisdiction over the issue that predominates in the bill.

Step 2: Committee Consideration. The first formal committee action on a bill or issue might be a hearing, which provides a forum at which committee members and the public can hear about the strengths and weaknesses of a proposal from selected parties – like key executive branch agencies, relevant industries, and groups representing interested citizens. Hearings are also a way to spotlight legislation to colleagues, the public, and the press. At the hearing, invited witnesses provide short oral remarks to the assembled committee,

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[1] Source: https://www.congress.gov/legislative-process.

but each witness also submits a longer written version of his or her feedback on the bill. After witnesses' oral statements, members of the committee take turns asking questions of the witnesses.

A committee markup is the key formal step a committee ultimately takes for the bill to advance to the floor. Normally, the committee chair chooses the proposal that will be placed before the committee for markup: a referred bill or a new draft text. At this meeting, which is typically open to the public, members of the committee consider possible changes to the proposal by offering and voting on amendments to it, including possibly a complete substitute for its text. A markup concludes when the committee agrees, by majority vote, to report the bill to the chamber.

Most House and Senate committees also establish subcommittees – subpanels of the full committee where members can further focus on specific elements of the policy area. The extent to which subcommittees play a formal role in policymaking – for example, by holding hearings or marking-up legislation prior to full committee consideration – varies by chamber and by committee tradition and practice. Whatever role a full committee allows its subcommittees to play, subcommittees cannot report legislation to the chamber; only full committees may do so.

Step 3: Calendars and Scheduling. Once a committee has reported a bill, it is placed on one of the respective chamber's calendars. These calendars are essentially a list of bills eligible for floor consideration; however, the bills on the calendars are not guaranteed floor consideration. In the House, majority party leadership decides which bills the House will consider, and in what order. In the Senate, majority party leadership does not use the same set of rules as the House to bring bills to the floor. One way the Senate can take up a bill is by agreeing to a motion to proceed to it. Once a Senator – typically the majority leader – makes such a motion that the Senate proceed to a certain bill, the Senate can then normally debate the motion to proceed. If it eventually agrees to the motion by a majority vote, the Senate can then begin consideration of the bill.

Step 4: House Floor Debate. The House considers bills under a variety of procedures, each of which differs in the amount of time allotted for debate and the opportunities given to members to propose amendments. Most bills are considered under the suspension of the rules procedure, which limits debate to 40 minutes and does not allow amendments to be offered by members on the floor. However, for the House to pass a bill under suspension of the rules requires two-thirds of members voting to agree, so this method is not designed for bills that do not have supermajority support in the House. Bills not considered on the House floor under suspension of the rules are typically considered instead under terms tailored for each particular bill. The House establishes these parameters on a case-by-case basis through the adoption of a special rule. Common provisions found in a special rule include selection of the text to be considered, limitations on debate, and limits on the amendments that can be offered on the floor. After any amendments are offered and debated, members vote on approval, and each amendment requires a simple majority to be agreed to.

Step 5: Senate Floor Debate. To consider a bill on the floor, the Senate first must agree to bring it up – typically by agreeing to a unanimous consent request or by voting to adopt a motion to proceed to the bill. Only once the Senate has agreed to consider a bill may Senators propose amendments to it. Most questions that the Senate considers are not subject to any debate limit and Senate rules provide few options to comprehensively limit the number and nature of amendments proposed to a bill. After this final period of consideration, the Senate will take a final vote on the bill.

Step 6: Resolving Differences. A bill must be agreed to by both chambers in the same form before it can be presented to the President. Once one chamber passes a bill, it is engrossed – that is, prepared in official form – and then sent (or messaged) to the other chamber. In a majority of cases, the second chamber simply agrees to the exact text passed by the first chamber, in which case Congress has then completed its action on the bill. In some cases, the second chamber instead decides to amend the first chamber's bill. The second chamber is often proposing, in effect, an alternative version of the bill, which may differ from the bill in minor or substantial ways. Once the second chamber agrees to this proposed alternative to the bill, it may send the proposal back to the first chamber for possible consideration and a vote. Sometimes, the resolution of differences between the House and Senate proposals may instead be accomplished through a conference committee. A conference committee is a temporary committee formed in relation to a specific bill with members drawn primarily from the committees with jurisdiction over the bill; its task is to negotiate a proposal that can be agreed to by both chambers. If a proposal can garner the support of a majority of the House conferees, and also separately, a majority of the Senate conferees, then the negotiated proposal is embodied in a conference report. For the bill to move to the next step in becoming law requires both chambers to agree to the conference report without changes.

Step 7: Presidential Actions. Once both chambers of Congress have each agreed to the bill, it is enrolled – that is, prepared in its final official form and then presented to the President. Beginning at midnight on the closing of the day of presentment, the President has ten days, excluding Sundays, to sign or veto the bill. If the bill is signed in that ten-day period, it becomes law. If the president declines to either sign or veto it – that is, he does not act on it in any way – then it becomes law without his signature. If the President vetoes the bill, it is returned to the congressional chamber in which it originated; that chamber may attempt to override the president's veto, though a successful override vote requires the support of two-thirds of those voting. If the vote is successful, the other chamber then decides whether or not to attempt its own override vote; here, as well, a successful override vote requires two-thirds of voting members to agree. Only if both chambers vote to override does the bill becomes law notwithstanding the President's veto. Bills that are ultimately enacted are delivered to the Office of the Federal Register at the National Archives, assigned a public law number, and included in the next edition of the United State Statutes at Large.

Appendix B

Policy Document Coding Instrument

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
Document Information			
Document title	Title of document		Use short title for bills.
Document date	Date of publication		
Serial number	Document serial number	Serial number (e.g., bill number)	
Document type	Type of policy document	1. Congressional Documents 11. House Bill (H.R.) 12. Senate Bill (S.) 13. House Resolution (H. Res.) 14. Senate Resolution (S. Res.) 15. Congressional Committee Print 16. Congressional Committee Hearing 17. Floor Comments/Speech 18. Public law 19. Other (please specify) 2. Presidential Documents 21. Proclamations 22. Executive orders 23. Speeches 24. Press conferences 25. Communications to Congress and Federal agencies 26. White House announcements 27. White House press releases 28. Other (please specify) 3. Government Agencies Documents 31. Research synthesis 32. White or position paper 33. Policy analysis (cost-benefit, projected impact, etc.) 34. Task force report	

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
Policy actor	The policymaking entity who generated the document	1. NEED TO UPDATE THESE 2. House 3. Senate 4. Congress (both House & Senate) 5. The U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. 6. The National Institutes of Health (NIH). 7. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC). 8. The Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality (AHRQ). 9. The Food and Drug Administration (FDA). 10. The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA). 11. The U.S. Department of Education (ED). 12. The Health Resources and Services Administration (HRSA). 13. The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). 14. The U.S. Department of Defense (DoD). 15. The Federal Trade Commission (FTC). 16. The Federal Communications Commission (FCC). 17. Other (please specify)	This should be a major unit or institution within the executive or legislative branch of government.
Policy subsystem	Specific policy subsystem or unit that generated the document	Congressional committee(s) and subcommittees, government agency office, etc.	Select and tag using this code the names of all specific units and sub-units identified in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.
Policy focus	Primary childhood obesity policy focus of document	1. need to update these	The policy focus can be typically inferred from the title or from the introductory section of the document. Select and tag using this code the title or description of the document. See Appendix C for a list of specific policy proposals that fit each category.

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
Setting	Procedure or proceedings described in document	1. Bill introduction 2. Legislative hearing (committee) 3. Oversight hearing (committee) 4. Investigative hearing (committee) 5. Field hearing (committee) 6. Bills amendment (committee) 7. Floor debate (comments on bill) 8. Second reading (proposed amendments) 9. Other (please specify)	This information will typically appear at the beginning of the document. The idea is to use the coding of this variable to locate information use across four steps in the policymaking process: formulation, information gathering, modification, and deliberation. Select and tag using this code the relevant word (bill, hearing, amendment, etc.).
Person Information			
Person name	Name of person referenced in the document		Select and tag every name listed in the document.
Person title	Official title of person	Title (e.g., Representative, Member, Dr., etc.)	This information will be complied separately.
Person party affiliation	Party affiliation (if any) of the person	1. Republican 2. Democrat 3. Independent 4. Non-partisan 5. Unknown	This information will be complied separately.
Person organizational affiliation	The person's institutional or organizational affiliation (whom this person represent)	Remember to use both parent and child codes.	Select and tag the corresponding organizational or institutional affiliation (e.g., Senate, USDA, Rutgers University, trade group, etc.) for each person listed in the document, if applicable.
Person role	Official role (if any) of the person in the proceedings described in the document (e.g., hearings, floor debates, bills)	Remember to use both parent and child codes.	Select and tag role information (e.g., Committee Chair, Ranking member, Staff member, etc.) for each individual participating in official proceedings.

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
Person contribution	Person contribution to the policy document or to the proceedings described in the document	1. Author of document 2. Co-author (if multiple authors are listed) 3. Bill sponsor 4. Bill co-sponsor (if multiple co-sponsors are listed) 5. Witness (if person provides oral/written testimony) 6. Speaker (person offering comments from the floor) 7. Other (please specify) 8. Not clear what role is (do not apply code)	The speaker category is reserved for representatives making comments from the floor during the debate proceedings. Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.
Evidence Mention Coding			
Supplier	Person or entity identified in document as supplying the evidence presented		Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document.
Source	Source of evidence	1. Generic (no specific source identified, e.g., "studies show") 2. University or academic research 3. Congressional research (e.g., GAO, OMB) 4. Non-partisan government research (e.g., CDC, IOM) 5. Partisan government research (e.g., White House, Surgeon General) 6. State-level agency research 7. International agency research (e.g., WHO) 8. Foundations or non-profit (e.g., think tank) research (e.g., RWJF, Rudd Center) 9. Advocacy or lobbying group research 10. Industry-sponsored research 11. News source 12. Expert testimonial 13. Anecdotal evidence 14. Other (please specify)	Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
Type of evidence	Type of research and non-research based evidence	1. Statistical fact 2. Research study 3. Research synthesis (e.g.., meta-analysis or systematic review) 4. Policy analysis (e.g., cost-effectiveness study) 5. Scientific public opinion poll (e.g., Roper, MBC News) 6. Expert opinion or testimony 7. Public, stakeholder, or constituent opinion 8. News story 9. Narrative or anecdote about an identifiable individual (e.g., self, family member, constituent) 10. Narrative or anecdote about an identifiable community (group of people with a similar characteristic) 11. Narrative or anecdote about an identifiable organization or institution (e.g., schools, industry) 12. Other (please specify)	Items 1-5 are generally considered research evidence. The remaining items are specific categories of evidence that is not research-based. Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.
Peer review	Was the research cited peer-reviewed?	1. Peer-reviewed 2. Not peer-reviewed	Only applies to research-based evidence. This information will be complied separately.
DOI	Publication Digital object identifier	Copy and paste the source's DOI	Only applies to research-based evidence. Digital object identifier (DOI) is a serial code used to uniquely identify electronic documents. If the DOI is already included with the citation of the source in the document, you should select and tag it with this code. Generally, a DOI will appear in the following format: doi:10.1177/1464884915579330 and will be somewhere on the first page or abstract.

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
Research methodology	Methodology used to produce the evidence in the research mention	1. Randomized experiment (lab) 2. Randomized experiment (field/RCT) 3. Non-randomized (quasi) experiment (lab) 4. Non-randomized (quasi) experiment (field) 5. Cross-sectional observational (survey) study 6. Longitudinal observational (survey) study 7. Secondary data analysis 8. Quantitative text analysis 9. Network analysis 10. Research synthesis (meta-analysis, systematic review) 11. Interview (individual or focus group) 12. Observations 13. Qualitative text analysis 14. Other (insert info as text)	Only applies to research-based evidence. This information will be complied separately.
Format	How is evidence presented?	1. Narrative (text) 2. Orally 3. Table 4. Figure 5. Video	Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.
Valence	Is evidence presented in the context of support, opposition, or neutral stance toward the topic/policy discussed?	1. Support 2. Opposition 3. Neutral	Valence can generally be inferred from the claims made based on the evidence and/or from the language used to contextualize the evidence. Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.
Interpretation	What, if any, claims are made (explicitly or implicitly) regarding the significance of the evidence presented?	1. Evidence suggests an objective status of problem (e.g., magnitude, burden) 2. Evidence suggests a policy problem (e.g., lack of resources or attention) 3. Evidence suggests cause(s) of the problem 4. Evidence suggests responsibility for the	Interpretation is about sense-making – what the evidence is presumed to suggest or what we should learn from it. In general, there are three ways in which evidence can be used in this context – to frame

Variable Name	Label	Possible Values/Codes	Specific Coding Instructions
		problem (e.g., personal vs. social or corporate responsibility) 5. Evidence suggests a probable solution to the program 6. Evidence suggests a particular policy response to the problem 7. Evidence suggests evaluation of policy response to the problem (e.g., as part of oversight) 8. Other (insert info as text)	(understand) the problem, to propose or advocate for a solution, and to suggest feasibility (including political feasibility) of pursuing or implementing a particular solution. Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document. Remember to use both parent and child codes.
Use of evidence	How (for what purpose) is evidence used?	1. Conceptual 2. Instrumental 3. Political 4. Tactical 5. Symbolic	Conceptual use of research evidence is for the purpose of informing a realistic understanding of the problem or conceiving a basic trajectory of a solution. Instrumental or substantive use of research is for the purpose of developing a feasible and effective policy response to the problem without being already committed to a particular solution. Political use of research is for the purpose advocating for or confirming the merit of understanding the problem in a particular way or pursuing a specific policy solution. Tactical or strategic use of research is for the purpose accelerating or slowing down policy decisions (e.g., suggesting that the available body of evidence is lacking or ambiguous). Symbolic or value-expressive use of research is for the purpose of linking is to a higher social value such as social justice. Use the relevant code to select and tag this information in the document.

Appendix C

Classification of Criminal Justice Reform Issues

Bail	Mandatory Sentencing	Uneven Application	Death Penalty
•	•	•	•